

Chapter 82 - Distrust

Jiang Shu's words stunned everyone for a moment, especially Yan Lin, who almost instantly stopped what she was doing.

Jiang Zhao couldn't figure out his aunt's intention. His gaze wandered between Yan Lin and Feng Yue for a moment, his expression somewhat hesitant: "Uh, Catherine and I wouldn't mind adding one more person..."

Everyone understood the implication of Jiang Zhao's words - whether Yan Lin could go still depended on Feng Yue's opinion.

Feng Hehai looked at his daughter's expression and tugged at his wife's arm, signaling her to stop talking.

Yan Lin also came to her senses at this moment. Looking at the silent Feng Yue, her heart sank - she didn't want to put Feng Yue in a difficult position.

Yan Lin took a deep breath, just about to say she didn't have time to go, when she heard Feng Yue's voice.

"Sure, let's go together." Speaking thus, Feng Yue slightly raised her eyes and directed her gaze to Yan Lin, who was watching her: "Miss Yan, are you free?"

Yan Lin nodded blankly: "Yes, yes I'm free."

Jiang Ming stood to the side, frowning tightly, wanting to persuade Feng Yue, but was stopped by Jiang Zhao.

The two exchanged glances, and Jiang Zhao patted her shoulder to signal her to calm down. Seeing his expression, Jiang Ming finally quieted down.

Just as Jiang Ming couldn't understand why Feng Yue would agree, Yan Lin also couldn't understand how Feng Yue had let her come along.

This matter was thus settled, and Feng Yue also breathed a slight sigh of relief.

Feng Yue actually didn't want Yan Lin to come along either, but she was even more unwilling to have any accidents occur.

The skiing trip was something her mother had actively proposed, and she could probably guess why her mother would do this.

Jiang Shu and Feng Hehai only had a partial understanding of what was between her and Yan Lin. They didn't know specifically what had happened between the two, but they would respect all of Feng Yue's decisions.

The period right after Feng Yue and Yan Lin's divorce was when Feng Yue was most resistant to Yan Lin, so when Yan Lin went to the Feng house to find Feng Yue during that time, Feng Mom absolutely wouldn't let her see anyone.

But ever since experiencing that incident at the private restaurant entrance, Feng Yue's attitude toward Yan Lin hadn't been so resistant, and both elders had seen how Yan Lin protected and cared for Feng Yue.

They clearly knew there were unresolved conflicts and problems between these two children, so Jiang Shu had proposed letting Yan Lin come along.

The reason Feng Yue agreed to this was more because of Yan Lin's conversation with her grandfather today.

She was afraid that during her time away, Yan Lin would come to her family members and say strange things, like the question Yan Lin had asked her grandfather.

Although it was very likely that Yan Lin wouldn't say anything, Feng Yue didn't dare gamble.

Feng Yue considered her plan perfect. She didn't want Yan Lin to become that unstable variable. So she could only bring her along during her time away.

Only by keeping an eye on her personally would she feel at ease.

Since it was confirmed that Yan Lin would come skiing with them the day after tomorrow, Yan Lin got up early the next morning to get herself ready.

She didn't have any skiing equipment here, so she needed to prepare in advance today.

When Yan Lin got in her car and was about to drive to the mall, an unexpected person knocked on her car window.

Yan Lin looked at the person standing outside the car, her face full of surprise: "Ah Yue?"

She hurriedly rolled down the window, looking at Feng Yue and then at her obviously morning-run attire: "How did you come here? Is there something you need from me? Why are you wearing so little clothing?"

Yan Lin quickly got out of the car, turning on the heater before getting out.

Feng Yue rubbed her nose tip and didn't answer Yan Lin's question, only saying: "I have something I want to say to you."

Seeing the white mist Feng Yue exhaled, Yan Lin nodded repeatedly: "Okay, okay, okay, then let's get in the car to talk. It's too cold outside."

Then Yan Lin pushed her into the passenger seat, then ran to the trunk to get a thick down jacket before getting back in the driver's seat.

"Put this on first. Today's temperature is quite low."

Feng Yue looked at the down jacket stuffed in her arms and was somewhat speechless. She ignored Yan Lin and instead asked: "Where are you going?"

"We're going skiing tomorrow, so I'm going to the mall to buy some necessities. I don't have anything here."

Feng Yue looked at the time, then lifted her chin: "Then let's go. We can talk on the way."

Yan Lin wasn't clear about her intentions and could only nod obediently and start the car, driving toward the mall.

The car was quiet for a while, and Yan Lin didn't know what to say either. She was now like a criminal waiting for judgment, with Feng Yue sitting beside her as the judge who would decide her fate.

It wasn't until the car had driven some distance and Feng Yue saw there weren't many pedestrians or vehicles on this road that she finally spoke: "The reason I nodded and agreed to let you come yesterday was only because I was afraid you would disrupt all my plans and reveal everything. So I hope you don't have any misunderstandings about tomorrow's trip."

The implication was: I still have no feelings for you, so don't have any futile fantasies.

Yan Lin felt like she had been sentenced to death by the judge. The atmosphere in the car became stagnant, her face pale and bloodless, her nails gripping the steering wheel tightly.

"I won't." Yan Lin gritted her teeth and made her final statement in a hoarse voice.

Feng Yue turned to look at her, then looked forward again: "I don't trust you, and I don't dare gamble."

Yan Lin's chest rose and fell violently, her emotions somewhat agitated. She stepped on the brakes, and due to inertia, both of them were thrust forward.

The car was quiet for a while, then Yan Lin heard rustling sounds from beside her. Then Feng Yue opened the car door, threw down the down jacket, and got out.

The sound of the car door closing again pulled Yan Lin back to reality. Looking at Feng Yue's departing figure without looking back, Yan Lin vented by hitting the steering wheel hard, then picked up the jacket from the passenger seat and chased after her.

Feng Yue hadn't gone far. Yan Lin caught up from the other side of the car and blocked her path.

Feng Yue was startled by the suddenly appearing figure and leaned back slightly: "I've already said everything I wanted to say, and I haven't delayed your time either. You can go do your own things. I can run back by myself."

Yan Lin stared at her intensely, the emotions churning in her eyes as if she wanted to devour the other person completely. But in the end, Yan Lin didn't say much more, just silently draped the thick down jacket over Feng Yue.

After doing this, Yan Lin stepped back slightly. The hair that had been tucked behind her ears was blown messy by the wind. She forced a miserable smile, as if mocking herself: "Ah Yue, you really know how to kill someone in the most painful way."

Feng Yue frowned, her expression displeased: "What do you mean by that?"

Yan Lin didn't answer her again, but reached out and pulled her wrist, walking toward the passenger side: "Wear more when you go morning running next time. I'll take you home."

Then, for the second time, Feng Yue was pushed into the passenger seat by Yan Lin.

The two didn't say another word until Yan Lin dropped Feng Yue off at her front door. After Feng Yue got out, looking at Yan Lin's departing car, she felt somewhat irritated.

Meanwhile, Yan Lin drove forward but didn't continue toward the mall. Instead, she drove straight home.

Since Feng Yue had said that bringing her along was a reluctant choice, there was no need for her, who wasn't welcome, to look forward to this trip.

Her expectations were probably also an emotion that would trouble Feng Yue.

Yan Lin turned on all the heating equipment in the house, even went into the bathroom and turned on all the hot water, letting the continuous steam fill the entire bathroom.

She had thought that everything she had done during this time, even if it couldn't make Feng Yue change her mind, would at least increase her trust a little.

But the look Feng Yue gave her in the car told her that everything she had done was futile.

Yan Lin sank herself into the warm bathtub, as if only by being wrapped in warm currents could she resist the bone-deep chill rising from her heart.

So cold—

When would she and Feng Yue finally welcome a warm spring?

In the end, Yan Lin didn't personally go select skiing equipment, but instead called the mall to have them randomly deliver a set to her house.

So on the day they were preparing to depart, Jiang Zhao was somewhat surprised when he saw the equipment she casually threw into the trunk.

"You're just bringing this set?" Although Jiang Zhao wasn't an expert at skiing, he and Jiang Ming went to ski resorts several times every year, so he had some understanding of this equipment.

As far as he knew, the set of equipment Yan Lin was bringing wasn't particularly good - at least someone who skied regularly wouldn't choose this set.

Yan Lin looked at the unsatisfactory equipment and avoided Jiang Zhao's gaze, nodding: "Mm, I just picked one randomly."

Jiang Zhao wanted to talk to her about equipment selection, but Jiang Ming was already urging them, so he had to give up. However, he thought the ski resort would also have equipment for sale, so he could help Yan Lin choose a new set then, and didn't bring it up again.

The four of them took only one car, and Jiang Zhao, as the only male, took on the responsibility of driving. Jiang Ming was her brother's regular passenger seat companion, but thinking that this would mean Yan Lin and Xiao Yue would sit together, she immediately changed her strategy and pulled Feng Yue into the back seat.

Yan Lin saw all this but didn't have any particular reaction, just quietly sat in the passenger seat.

Jiang Zhao looked through the rearview mirror at Feng Yue, who was looking at the scenery outside in the back seat, then glanced at Yan Lin, who was particularly silent today, and couldn't help but sigh inwardly.

Probably these two had another incident they didn't know about.

Seeing these two hadn't said a word to each other, Jiang Ming's lips curved slightly upward, and she immediately had an idea.

She had been worried before about whether Feng Yue still liked that Yan Lin, so she hadn't mentioned introducing friends to her.

But looking at it now, it probably wouldn't be so easy for these two to reconcile¹.

Why not help her friend out?

Jiang Ming took out her phone and quickly sent two messages to someone.

Jiang Ming: [Location Pin]

Jiang Ming: Ski resort, come quickly.

Footnotes:

¹ Reconcile (破镜重圆): Literally "broken mirror made whole again," a Chinese idiom referring to a separated couple getting back together.